h. What did Nagen uncle tell about Sanyal?

i. In what way was Mr. Sanyal's behaviour strange?

I noticed a sudden change in Aditya's expression and I asked him the reason for it. Without answering me, he asked Nagen uncle who the gentleman was and what he did.

Nagen uncle replied, 'Sasanka Sanyal. What can be done? He leads a cursed life – gone crazy, I think, but has not forgotten any incident of the past. Sold his lands to get his only daughter married. He lost his wife and only son last year. Since then he is somewhat changed – not really normal.' 'Where does he stay?'

'He stays with a friend of his father's – Jogesh Kabiraj. Sasanka comes here, has tea and biscuits and always remembers to pay – having an acute sense of self-respect. But how long things will remain like this, I don't know'.

j. What did Nagen uncle tell about Sanyal's past life?

k. How did Sanyal show that he had a sense of self-respect?

Having paid our bill and ascertained the location of Jogesh Kabiraj's house, we got into the car. Aditya was at the wheel. He expressed the wish to visit his house. 'So you do want to see your house after all?' I said.

'It has become essential to do so,' Aditya replied. His nerves seemed overwrought for some reason. We soon reached the house, which was surrounded by high walls. Even from the ruins, one could easily imagine how grand it must have been once upon a time.

We entered the building, climbed up the stairs and reached the attic on the second floor of the house.

'This was my favourite room,' said Aditya. The attic has always been a favourite with children. It is in the attic that the child seems to be in a world of its own.

A portion of a wall of the attic had crumbled down, and through the 'window' that had been created, we could see the sky, the fields, a part of the rice mill, the spire of the old temple. In the whole house, the attic had probably been the worst hit by wind and weather. The floor was strewn with twigs and straw and pigeon droppings. Among other things, there was a broken cricket bat, the remains of an armchair and a wooden packing case.



Aditya got on top of the packing case and pushed his hand inside the ventilator, thus upsetting a sparrow's nest, a part of which fell to the ground. However, he heaved a sigh of relief when he had got what he had been looking for. When I

10th English_Book.indb 96 26-02-2019 16:24:31